

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF KINGS

JERMAINE WALKER,

## SUMMONS

Plaintiff,

Index No.:

-against-

The Basis of Venue is:

Location of Incident

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER JASON  
DOWDELL, Shield No. 24232, and POLICE OFFICER  
JOHN DOES NUMBERS ONE THROUGH TEN,Plaintiff designates Kings  
County as the place of trial.

Defendants.

## To the above named Defendants:

**You are hereby summoned** to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York  
February 1, 2020

Yours, etc.

CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC  
CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.  
Attorney for Plaintiff  
30 Broad Street Suite 702  
New York, New York 10004  
(646)-524-6026TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007  
POLICE OFFICER JASON DOWDELL, Shield No. 24232, NYPD Criminal  
Intel Section, 1 Police Plaza, Room 1100, New York, NY 10007

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X

JERMAINE WALKER,

Plaintiff,

**INDEX NO.:**

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER JASON  
DOWDELL, Shield No. 24232, and POLICE OFFICER  
JOHN DOES NUMBERS ONE THROUGH TEN,

**JURY TRIAL DEMANDED**

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Plaintiff JERMAINE WALKER, by his attorneys, Caitlin Robin & Associates, PLLC, as  
and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

### **PRELIMINARY STATEMENT**

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On March 21, 2019, at approximately 7:00 a.m., plaintiff Jermaine Walker was subjected to an unlawful stop, frisk, search, detention, and false imprisonment, while lawfully present inside 249A Kosciuszko Street in Brooklyn, New York. Plaintiff spent approximately 5 days unlawfully in police custody. Thereafter, the defendant police officers denied plaintiff the right to a fair trial by forwarding false information to the District Attorney's Office. All charges against Plaintiff were dismissed and sealed on September 27, 2019. Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional and common law rights when the individual defendants unlawfully searched, confined, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, maliciously prosecuted, and denied plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

### **PARTIES**

2. Plaintiff JERMAINE WALKER is a resident of the state of New York.

3. POLICE OFFICER JASON DOWDELL, Shield No. 24232, is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

4. POLICE OFFICER JASON DOWDELL, Shield No. 24232, was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 79<sup>th</sup> Precinct.

5. POLICE OFFICER JASON DOWDELL, Shield No. 24232, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

6. New York City Police Officers John Does #1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.

7. Police Officer John Does Does #1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

8. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

9. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a Police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

10. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the CITY OF NEW YORK in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.

11. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on December 18, 2019.

12. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and THE CITY OF NEW YORK has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

13. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

14. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

### **STATEMENT OF FACTS**

15. On March 21, 2019 at approximately 7:00 A.M., plaintiff was lawfully present inside 249A Kosciuszko, in Brooklyn, New York.

16. The Defendant police officers unlawfully handcuffed Plaintiff.

17. At no time prior to being stopped by the officers did plaintiff commit a crime or behave in a manner that gave the police officers a reasonable and objective basis to believe he had committed or was committing a crime.

18. The Defendant Officers searched Plaintiff and found no contraband or anything illegal on him.

19. At no point in time did plaintiff resist arrest in any way.

20. Defendants then drove Plaintiff to the 79<sup>th</sup> Precinct, where Plaintiff was fingerprinted, photographed, and unlawfully detained in a holding cell.

21. Thereafter Plaintiff was transferred to Kings County central booking.

22. The Defendant Officers falsely stated to the Kings County District Attorneys Office that Plaintiff had committed the crime of Criminal Possession of a controlled substance despite knowing that they lacked a legal and factual basis to allege that Plaintiff committed any crime.

23. On March 22, 2019, after approximately 24 hours unlawfully in police custody, Plaintiff was arraigned in Kings County Criminal Court and charged with crimes that the defendant officers had no basis to allege that he committed.

24. Based on the Officers false allegations, a Judge set bail on Plaintiff.

25. Plaintiff remained incarcerated at Rikers Island for 5 days, until he was released on the 180/80 due to insufficient evidence presented to the Grand Jury.

26. The Kings County District Attorneys office moved to dismiss and seal all charges against Plaintiff on September 27, 2019.

27. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably searching, seizing, falsely arresting and imprisoning, denying the right to due process and a fair trial, and maliciously prosecuting of plaintiff.

28. The unlawful, search, seizure, false arrest and imprisonment, denial of the right to a fair trial, and malicious prosecution of plaintiff by the individually named defendants caused plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

### **FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights**

29. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 28 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

30. The individually named police officer defendants while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

31. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, psychological and economic injuries.

### **SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **False Arrest and False Imprisonment**

32. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 31 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

33. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine plaintiff and, in fact, confined plaintiff, and plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

34. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

35. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

36. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

37. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

### **THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Unlawful Search**

38. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 37 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

39. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and search employed by defendants herein terminated plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

40. Defendants lacked probable cause to search plaintiff.

41. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

42. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

43. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

44. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

### **FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Violation of Plaintiff's Fifth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights**

##### **Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process**

45. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 44 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein

46. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

47. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

48. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

49. In withholding/creating false evidence against plaintiff Jermaine Walker, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, defendants violated plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

50. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff Jermaine Walker, sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, lost earnings and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

51. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

52. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

53. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

## **FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

### **Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress**

54. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 53 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

55. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to plaintiff, Jermaine Walker. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to plaintiff and violated plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

56. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to plaintiff and violated plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

57. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

58. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

59. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

60. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

### **SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision**

61. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 60 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

62. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

63. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

### **SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Failure to Intervene**

64. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 63 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

65. The defendants that did not physically touch plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

66. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.



67. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

68. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

69. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

70. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

71. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

### **EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Malicious Prosecution**

72. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 71 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

73. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the laws of the United States Constitution, State of New York and New York State common law.

74. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against plaintiff.

75. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against plaintiff and for each of the charges for which they were prosecuted.

76. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned dates.

77. Plaintiff was subjected to a post-arraignment deprivation of liberty sufficient to implicate plaintiff's Fourth Amendment rights.

78. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

79. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

80. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

**JURY DEMAND**

81. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

**PRAYER FOR RELIEF**

**WHEREFORE**, plaintiff JERMAINE WALKER demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law. That the plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated:           New York, New York  
February 1, 2020

By:   
CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC  
CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.  
Attorney for Plaintiff  
30 Broad Street Suite 702  
New York, New York 10004  
(646)-524-6026

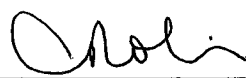
TO:   THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007  
POLICE OFFICER JASON DOWDELL, Shield No. 24232, NYPD Criminal  
Intel Section, 1 Police Plaza, Room 1100, New York, NY 10007

**ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION**

**CAITLIN ROBIN**, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a partner of the law firm of **CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York  
February 1, 2020

  
\_\_\_\_\_  
CAITLIN ROBIN

